

Module 3

Slash Commands

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

WHY -- Why This Matters

You find yourself typing the same requests to Claude over and over: "update the log", "find that file", "summarise what we did". That's wasted time and mental energy.

This module gives you three layers of control:

1. **Slash commands** -- shortcuts for tasks you repeat (type `/log` instead of a paragraph)
2. **Skills** -- multi-step reasoning that commands can't do alone (like researching a topic from the web)
3. **Plan Mode** -- a "think before you build" workflow for anything non-trivial

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'dark', 'themeVariables': {'nodeTextColor': '#e8e8e8',
'primaryTextColor': '#e8e8e8', 'secondaryTextColor': '#cccccc', 'tertiaryTextColor':
'cccccc', 'clusterBkg': 'transparent', 'clusterBorder': '#8b949e'}}}%
flowchart LR
    A["Slash Command<br/>single task"] --> B["Skill<br/>multi-step<br/>reasoning"]
    B --> C["Agent<br/>autonomous<br/>specialist"]
    D["Plan Mode<br/>think first"] --> A
    D --> B

    style A fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
    style B fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
    style C fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
    style D fill:none,stroke:#58a6ff,stroke-width:2px,color:#c9d1d9
```

Before: You type out full requests every time. **After:** `/log` does it in one second. `/web-researcher` gathers information from any website. Plan Mode stops Claude from rushing ahead.

WHAT -- What You'll Learn

Part 1: Slash Commands

Slash commands are shortcuts stored as `.md` files. The file name becomes the command name.

```
your-project/
├── CLAUDE.md
├── MASTER-SESSION-LOG.md
└── .claude/
    └── commands/
        ├── status.md      → /status
        ├── log.md         → /log
        └── find.md        → /find
```

Each file contains a description + a prompt. That's it.

Anatomy of a command:

```
description: What this command does (shows in help)

The prompt that Claude runs when you type the command.
Use $ARGUMENTS for whatever the user types after the command name.
```

EXAMPLE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/status</code>	Quick project health check
<code>/log</code>	Update the session log
<code>/find keyword research</code>	Search for files matching a description
<code>/summarise</code>	Bullet-point summary of the session

Part 2: Skills

A skill is like a slash command with brains. Where a command runs a single prompt, a skill does multi-step reasoning -- it reads files, checks context, makes decisions, then gives you a result.

You get 3 starter skills with this module:

SKILL	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
<code>/find</code>	Searches your project using plain English	"find the supplier spreadsheet"
<code>/web-researcher</code>	Researches any topic or URL from the web	"research competitor pricing strategies"
<code>/content-research-writer</code>	Writing partner that helps you draft from source material	Turn research into an article

The chain: Research a topic -> feed it to the content writer -> get a polished article. Skills working together is where the real power is.

Skills live in `.claude/skills/` (not `.claude/commands/`). Copy the 3 files from this module's `skills/` folder into your project's `.claude/skills/` folder.

```

your-project/
└─ .claude/
    ├── commands/      ← slash commands (simple)
    └─ skills/         ← skills (multi-step)
        ├── find.md
        ├── web-researcher.md
        └─ content-research-writer.md

```

Part 3: Plan Mode

Plan Mode is a workflow toggle that says: "Think before you build."

How it works:

1. Press **Shift+Tab** to enter Plan Mode
2. Claude analyses, outlines, and proposes a plan
3. You review and approve (or adjust)
4. Claude executes the approved plan
5. Back to Plan Mode for the next thing

When to use it:

- Anything that changes multiple files
- Tasks where the approach isn't obvious
- When you want to understand what Claude will do before it does it

When to skip it:

- Quick fixes (typos, small edits)

- Simple questions
- Tasks where you've given very specific instructions

The cycle: **Plan -> Approve -> Execute -> Back to Plan**

This prevents Claude from rushing ahead and making changes you didn't expect. It's the single best habit for staying in control.

HOW -- The Self-Drive Process

Setting Up Slash Commands

1. **You read** this README (done)
2. **You give Claude the self-drive file** -- open `SLASH-COMMANDS-SELF-DRIVE.md` , copy the contents, paste into Claude Code
3. **Claude asks you 3 questions** -- what tasks you repeat, where your folder is, which command to create first
4. **Claude creates your commands folder** and first commands

Installing the 3 Skills

Copy the skill files from this module into your project:

1. Open the `skills/` folder in this module
2. Copy all 3 files (`find.md` , `web-researcher.md` , `content-research-writer.md`)
3. Paste them into your project's `.claude/skills/` folder
4. If the folder doesn't exist, create it: `.claude/skills/`
5. **Restart Claude Code** after copying the files (skills load at startup)

Or ask Claude: "Create a `.claude/skills/` folder and copy these skill files into it."

Verify it worked: Type `/web-researcher` in Claude Code. If it appears in the list, you're set. If it doesn't, restart Claude Code -- skills are registered when Claude starts up.

Tips

- **One command = one job.** Don't try to do everything in one command
- **Clear names.** `/log` , `/status` , `/find` -- not `/cmd1` , `/process`
- **Test each command once** before relying on it
- **Start with Plan Mode** for anything beyond a quick fix
- **Skills not showing up?** Restart Claude Code. Skills in `.claude/skills/` are loaded at startup, not mid-conversation

Common Questions

QUESTION	ANSWER
Where does <code>.claude/</code> go?	In your project root, same level as CLAUDE.md
Different commands per project?	Yes, each project has its own <code>.claude/commands/</code>
What if I type a command that doesn't exist?	Claude tells you. No harm done
How many commands can I have?	As many as you like. Most people use 5-10 regularly
Commands vs skills?	Commands = single prompt. Skills = multi-step reasoning
Also see <code>ADDITIONAL-RESOURCES/</code> for a full reference of built-in slash commands.	

WHAT IF -- What This Unlocks

You now have three layers of control:

- **CLAUDE.md** (Module 1) -- who you are
- **Master Log** (Module 2) -- where you've been
- **Commands + Skills + Plan Mode** (this module) -- how you work fast and stay in control

From here:

- **Module 4** -- MCPs connect Claude to external services (calendars, browsers, files on your computer)
- **Module 5** -- AI agents that work autonomously on Amazon-specific tasks

Module 3 | AI Workshop Curriculum | SSL 2026